

## Muncie Redevelopment Commission July 23, 2026

| Meeting Metadata | Details                                                                                               |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Video Recording  | <a href="https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FqW4QhuwfA8">https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FqW4QhuwfA8</a> |
| Publication Date | 2026-07-24T01:00:03Z                                                                                  |
| Target Category  | muncie_city                                                                                           |

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## Muncie Redevelopment Commission Meeting Summary

**Meeting Date:** July 23, 2026

**Body:** Muncie Redevelopment Commission (MRC)

### 1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at [00:00:15](#), explicitly identifying it as the July 23, 2026 meeting of the Muncie Redevelopment Commission.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Mr. Miller, Mr. Pilla, Mr. Rawlings, Miss Waggley
  - **Absent:** Mr. Bishop, Mr. Low

### 2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was reviewed and approved as presented by voice vote [00:01:10](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The previous meeting memoranda were approved with corrections noted regarding the table, with Mr. Rawlings abstaining since he was not present at the prior meeting [00:01:41](#).

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### 3. Substantive Business & Board Action

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- **00:06:26 Register of Claims**
  - **Presenter:** Craig Ryder
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the register of claims sent out the previous week, noting a couple of larger bond payments included in the current batch.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by voice vote **00:07:05**.
- **00:07:11 Funding Request: Police Department Equipment**
  - **Presenter:** Jeff (City Staff)
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested \$100,000 to assist the Muncie Police Department in purchasing essential public safety equipment (such as drone support and vehicles). Staff noted a recent state statute change now explicitly permits redevelopment commissions to fund public safety projects.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by voice vote **00:09:19**.
- **00:09:21 Funding Request: Retirement of Garmong Legacy Debt**
  - **Presenter:** Jeff (City Staff)
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested funds (approximately \$390,000 including accumulated interest at roughly 7%) to retire a legacy debt owed to Garmong Construction incurred by a previous administration for downtown property acquisition adjacent to "The Point." Staff expressed a desire to clear the lingering debt with a contractor who might bid on future work.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by voice vote **00:11:12**.
- **00:11:14 Funding Request: KPEP Energy Park / Old Danner Site Flood Plain Mitigation & LOMR**
  - **Presenter:** Jeff (City Staff)
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed the tax-delinquent KPEP Energy Park property (old Danner site / old wire mill on East Jackson) which carries significant back taxes and unpaid revolving loan fund debt. Requested approximately \$35,000 for a survey and Letter of Map Revision (LOMR) application to remove the property from the flood plain so it can be sold, recover taxes, and repay the revolving loan fund. Staff plans to seek a promissory note or cost-sharing from other entities like GMED (Economic Development Alliance) and the county.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote **00:15:12**.
- **00:15:16 Assignment of GW Purchase Agreement**
  - **Presenter:** Jeff (City Staff)
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Staff reported that the previous developer failed to plat or build a planned 14-townhome development adjacent to "The Point" within the required 2024 timeline. Staff negotiated an assignment of the purchase agreement to a new developer (the same developer handling "The Point"). The amended agreement requires the immediate payment of \$250,000 upon execution and

replaces the townhomes with a \$15 million, 50-unit residential apartment building featuring 2,500 to 5,000 square feet of ground-floor commercial space, constructed on a staggered timeline alongside The Point.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote [00:20:30](#).
- [00:20:33](#) **Economic Development Agreement (EDA): Homes on Walnut Street**
  - **Presenter:** Jeff (City Staff)
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Advantage Built Homes LLC seeks to develop single-family homes for sale on two city-owned lots (plus a third city-owned parcel) north of the new town development on Walnut Street. The homes will be built to comply with neighborhood standards without variance requests. The EDA includes default and remedies clauses requiring timely construction commencement to align with state "Ready 2" grant draw deadlines ([00:25:20](#)).
  - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
    - [00:46:11 Rachel](#) (Vice President, McKinley Neighborhood Association): Voiced concerns regarding lack of advance neighborhood notice and collaboration prior to agreements coming before the commission.
    - [00:48:07 Rebecca Hannah](#): Noted that the target lots are zoned R5, requiring a minimum lot width of 50 feet, whereas the lots are 40 feet wide, meaning variances will likely be required unless zoning records are incorrect.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 3–1 (Mr. Rawlings voted "no") [00:32:06](#).
- [00:32:20](#) **Facade Grant Applications**
  - **Presenter:** Mr. Pilla
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented two facade grant applications for approval:
    1. **Cornerstone Center for the Arts** (500 block of East Washington): Repaving parking lot. Total cost: \$43,670; Grant request: \$21,835.
    2. **Saks Capital** (1125 South Walnut): Door and awning replacement. Total cost: \$10,617.25; Grant request: \$5,308.62.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote [00:34:24](#).
- [00:34:28](#) **Muncie Downtown Development Partnership Agreement Renewal**
  - **Presenter:** Amanda (Muncie Downtown Development)
  - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested renewal of the downtown partnership agreement for a two-year term (2027 and 2028) at the current funding level of \$80,000 annually. The agreement includes new language for regular reporting regarding MRC fund expenditures and activities.
  - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 3–1 (Mr. Rawlings voted "no") [00:38:51](#).

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## 4. City, Land Bank, & Administrative Updates

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- **City Updates** ([00:03:01](#)):

- Reported on the successful “Touch Truck” and park ribbon cutting at “The Point” (approx. 500 attendees).
- The Metropolitan Planning Commission approved the redesigned wireless communications tower (elevated platform to avoid debris trapping in flood zones), anticipating an upfront payment of \$96,000 and \$500 monthly for 30 years (\$280,000 total).
- The Whitley single-family home development project is a “no-go” as single-family home building and rental rates are not financially viable for the developer.
- Mall demolition has commenced with the old theater removed, and interior salvage ongoing at Sears and JCPenney.
- **Land Bank Update (00:39:04 - Nate Howard):**
  - Zero new acquisitions; successfully sold 22 additional properties for the Old West End project to Affordable Home Matters (CDFI from Intend Indiana).
  - Applied for operational grants from Ball Brothers Foundation and Centerpoint Energy Foundation; received a small grant from the Office of Community Engagement for a planning intern.
  - First Friday (August 7th) will feature Ashley Bridges from Intend Indiana’s Build Fund.
  - Working with stakeholders on Whitley neighborhood land strategies and pre-approved housing design programs in collaboration with Ball State architecture and planning departments. Strategic planning focus groups are underway.

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## 5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

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- **00:46:11 Rachel:** (Captured under Substantive Business - Walnut Street EDA regarding neighborhood notification processes).
- **00:48:07 Rebecca Hannah:** (Captured under Substantive Business - Walnut Street EDA regarding R5 zoning lot width requirements).
- **00:49:01 Rick Answer** (Newsmen, author): Expressed concern that the meeting start time (8:00 AM vs. 9:00 AM) was posted in a way that violated open meetings laws, requested openness regarding the Garmong property purchase, and questioned the status of “The Point” mixed-use building project.

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## 6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

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- **Board/Staff Announcements:** Discussion among commissioners and staff regarding neighborhood outreach, legal representation, and the application of eminent domain (which commissioners firmly disclaimed interest in using).
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned at **00:55:38**, with the next regular meeting scheduled for **August 20, 2026 00:55:40**.

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